

Comparing the Collections

Canadiana includes two distinct collections—Canadiana and Héritage. Stewarded by the Canadian Research Knowledge Network (CRKN), these collections are more than 69 million pages of diverse materials that reflect Canada’s history and the experiences of its peoples, made freely available through the financial support of CRKN member libraries. Compare highlights of the two collections below to learn more about what makes them distinct.

	Canadiana Collection	Héritage Collection
Primary focus	Published Canadian materials including books, serials, maps, and government publications	Archival microfilm records from Library and Archives Canada
Date range	c. 1500 to present day	c. 1500 to 1985
Collection size	Approximately 31.5 million pages (98,000 titles)	Approximately 37.5 million pages (over 1,000 archival collections)
Genealogy materials	Some published genealogical materials (such as city directories)	Strong coverage, including family, immigration, and voters' records
Indigenous history	Books and periodicals in Indigenous languages and selected materials by Indigenous authors	Strong in archival records and federal government files
Military records	Selected published military histories	Extensive military archival documentation
Newspapers and magazines	Yes	No
Maps	Yes	No

Access model	Available at no charge through the Canadiana platform	Available at no charge through the Canadiana platform
Best for	Newspaper and periodical research, Canadian literature and government publications, and print culture analysis	Primary source archival research, genealogy, and government history
Browse now	More about Canadiana	More about Héritage

As resources developed over decades of collecting and preserving documents, CRKN acknowledges that the Canadiana Collections contain material that is offensive and biased, contributing to an incomplete, distorted, and harmful story of Canada. We are dedicated to redefining the principles guiding the collections, helping to ensure that future development is firmly grounded in our commitment to reconciliation and justice. Currently, CRKN is [expanding the collection](#) with content from member and stakeholder collections while prioritizing at-risk materials, newspapers, and content that represents the diversity of the Canadian population.

The Canadiana Collections are overseen by the [Preservation and Access Committee](#) (PAC) and the PAC's sub-committees, the [Canadiana Content Sub-Committee](#) and the [Platform Technical Sub-Committee](#). To learn more about the Canadiana Collections, contact us at info@crkn.ca.